



Journaling can be a good way to process and record emotions as you approach the end of your pregnancy. It is normal to experience a range of feelings, from fear and anxiety to excitement and curiosity.

PREPARING FOR LABOR

The period before labor starts can last for hours or even days, particularly with a first labor. So that you can manage when you go into labor, you need to take care of yourself during this prelabor stage.

- **Stay well rested** so that you aren't completely exhausted when you go into labor. If you're having trouble resting due to anxiety, try practicing some relaxation techniques.
- **Trouble sleeping is usually due to physical discomfort**, such as being too hot, not being able to get into a comfortable position, or having trouble breathing from congestion. Measures that can help include using body pillows, a dehumidifier, and fans or air conditioning in the summer.
- **Continue eating to keep your energy levels up** and provide fuel for the days ahead. You may not feel like eating a large meal; instead, eat little and often.
- **If you're suffering with back pain, try showering in warm water or taking a warm bath.** However, be careful when showering, since pregnancy increases your chances of feeling dizzy, and avoid a prolonged bath in very hot water since this may not be good for your baby.
- **A lower back massage is comforting** and a good way to relax and ease discomfort—ask your partner to give you a soothing massage.